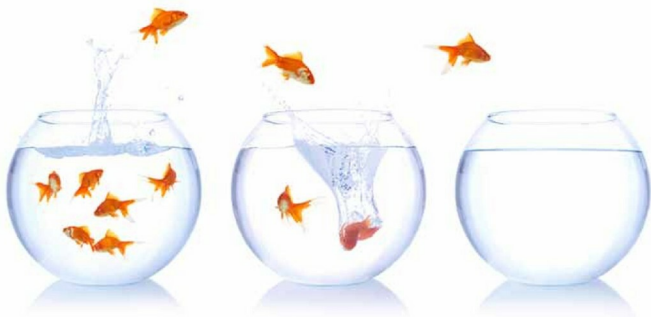




Unix-to-Linux Migration Has Come of Age

If you've often wondered whether you ought to migrate your Unix system to Linux, this article will answer your question!

The driving force behind every migration is the promise of a better tomorrow. It's no wonder, then, that a good number of migrations, human, animal or otherwise, have resulted in a positive ROI. Let's take migrations in IT systems. Shrinking IT budgets, coupled with the cost advantages that Linux-Intel platforms provide are driving migrations to Linux. I have noticed an increasing number of enterprises seeking information on Linux migrations, as well as opting for the migration—and the numbers are growing.

With migrations come the herd and crowd mentality. It is said that it takes a mere 5 per cent minority to influence a crowd's direction and that the remaining 95 per cent will follow for sure (findings from a research conducted by the University of Leeds, 2008). Applying these statistics to IT systems migration, it's tempting to infer that organisations migrating to Linux are being driven by the herd mentality.

So, should you follow the herd? You'll discover the

answer to that shortly. Meanwhile, let me put it in simple and direct terms: "If it can be migrated, it *should* be migrated." You'll learn why in the course of this article.

But before we get there, let us touch upon some important aspects of the migration itself, including *when* to migrate, what to look for in migration vendors and a few best practices.

When should I migrate?

It's not a question any more of *whether* organisations should migrate; it's merely a question of *when*. There are no ready-made answers for when you should consider migration. A considerable amount of calculation goes into deciding when you should take the plunge—and it all boils down to a reasonable risk-reward ratio. A good yardstick is the ROI that you can expect from this migration in a fixed time-frame. Your quest for positive ROI should be pegged